



FIRST NATIONS

CANADA'S NATIVE PEOPLES

modern-day Canada, only about two percent are aboriginal. This category is divided into three: the First Nations, or Indians (like the

The world of the Iroquois

The Iroquois are a federation of First Nations people (Mohawk, Oneida, Cayuga, Onondaga, Seneca, and Tuscarora) who originally inhabited the forests of the northeastern United States and southeastern Canada. Today, more than half live in Canada. The Iroquois call themselves *Haudenosaunee*, meaning “people of the longhouse,” after their large, traditional dwellings.

BADGES OF HONOR

Two generations of Mohawks attend a traditional ceremony. Although historically Iroquois men wear feathers as a badge of their nation, the style of headdress (and shirt) shown here is usually associated with Plains Indians. Today, many groups have adopted Plains dress to express their pan-Indian identity.



SIX NATIONS POW WOW

Throughout much of North America, the pow wow—a festive meeting between the members of one or more nations—is a native tradition. This one, held at the Six Nations Iroquois Reserve near Brantford, Ontario, features all the singing, dancing, feasting, and color that characterize these celebrations.



NATIVE SPORT

The ancient Iroquois game of *tewaarathon*, known as lacrosse, is widely enjoyed in many countries. Today, the Iroquois Nationals are the only indigenous team in the world to take part in an international sporting competition. Here, a group of Mohawk boys play informally.